

Syrian Arab Republic Humanitarian Situation Report No. 3



A child receives non-formal education in a child-friendly environment through the Self-Learning Programme, in Wadi Ghazal Qah, in northern countryside of Idlib @UNICEF

Reporting Period: 23 to 29 December 2024

Highlights

- More than 627,000 people including more than 275,000 children remain newly displaced across the country, mostly in Idlib and Aleppo governorates. Approximately 522,000 people who were displaced after 27 November have returned to their areas of origin.
- Damages to the critical infrastructure at Tishreen Dam and Al Khafseh water station have significantly reduced water supplies to Aleppo city and its surrounding areas. Tishreen Dam remains non-operational, affecting water access for over 400,000 residents.
- UNICEF has successfully completed the testing of the Ein Al Baida station, which will provide safe drinking water to over 260,000 people in Al-Bab City and surrounding villages in Aleppo governorate.
- During the reporting period, 12,124 individuals received primary healthcare consultations, including 6,935 children (3,488 girls and 3,447 boys) and 5,189 adults (4551 women and 638 men).
- UNICEF reached 4,864 people, including 4,063 children (1,765 girls and 2,298 boys), through the cash-plus programme.
- UNICEF and its partners supported access to quality formal and non-formal education and provision of supplies for 32,069 children (17,666 girls and 14,403 boys).

Funding Overview and Partnerships

UNICEF Syria's Humanitarian Action for Children (HAC) appeal for 2025 requires US\$ 488 million. Currently, only 11 per cent of this amount has been secured.¹ The situation is critical, with rising needs among newly displaced individuals and growing vulnerabilities. UNICEF will update its funding requirements once more accurate data and needs assessments are available, ensuring the funding requirements align more closely with the updated needs.

To address the immediate needs arising from the recent escalation and displacement, a three-month Emergency Response Plan (ERP) is being developed. This plan will outline the additional needs and associated funding requirements for a rapid and scaled-up response.

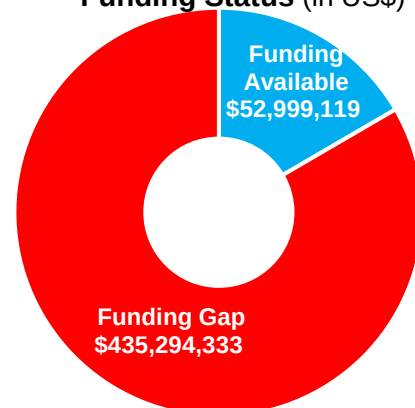
UNICEF expresses its gratitude to all public and private partners for their support. The flexible humanitarian funding and core resources provided by these partners enable UNICEF to respond

Situation in Numbers

- ➔ **627,000** Internally displaced people (IDPs) As of 7 January
OCHA Flash Update No. 10
- ➔ **Over 275,000 children** are displaced
UNICEF estimates based on OCHA IDP figures
- ➔ **25,800 people in Northeast Syria** are living in Emergency Collective Centres
OCHA Flash Update No.10

UNICEF Appeal 2025 US\$ 488 million

Funding Status (in US\$)



¹ Funding status shows a lower number than the UNICEF SitRep No.2. The reduction is attributable to the year-end consolidation and excludes some specific funding that cannot be used for the current response in line with the specific funding conditionalities.

effectively to urgent and unforeseen needs.² In particular, UNICEF would like to thank the Governments of Austria and the United Kingdom Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office for their generous and timely contributions to the ongoing response. UNICEF also acknowledges the valuable humanitarian contributions made by partners in 2024, including its National Committees.

Without additional resources, UNICEF's ability to provide essential assistance to children will be hindered, leading to increased protection risks and impacting UNICEF's capacity to deliver life-saving interventions.

Situation Overview and Humanitarian Needs

Syria is grappling with severe economic and humanitarian crises amid ongoing insecurity. Hostilities have been reported in Aleppo, Deir-ez-Zor, Hama, Homs, Latakia, Quneitra, Rural Damascus, and Tartous governorates, resulting in civilian casualties. In Aleppo, hostilities, criminal activity, and sniping in certain areas pose significant challenges for UNICEF and its partners. Armed clashes persist in Menbij, Ain al-Arab, and around the Tishreen Dam. The security situation in rural Aleppo remains unstable, restricting access to essential services such as education and child protection. Damage to schools and a lack of resources for transport and supplies are disrupting education, although children in Aleppo and rural areas still attend school. The instability also heightens risks for IDPs and vulnerable populations, with power and telecom outages further complicating operations. In Homs and Hama, increased violence and the establishment of new checkpoints are limiting movement in some neighbourhoods of Homs City.

In northeast Syria, the security situation remains fluid and unpredictable, and the humanitarian crisis continues to be dire. Although the number of IDPs in 193 emergency collective centres has decreased from 40,000 to 25,800 over the past week,³ significant challenges remain. This includes severe shortages of water, sanitation, and hygiene (WASH) services in several collective centres in Qamishli, including inadequate water supply and limited sanitation facilities. Additionally, women have reported feeling unsafe in these conditions. Moreover, the UNHAS flights are still non-operational limiting access to the Northeast Syria.

The economic crisis in Syria is marked by limited financial liquidity, declining public services such as water and electricity, and soaring oil and transportation prices. These factors limit humanitarian operations in some areas, while key infrastructures still require rehabilitation. For example, the Tishreen Dam in Aleppo has been non-operational since 10 December, depriving 413,000 people in Menbij and Kobani of water and electricity.⁴

This situation has dire humanitarian consequences, particularly for children and their ability to attend school. Many schools and education facilities require rehabilitation after years of conflict, with those in high-risk areas needing mine clearance and unexploded ordnance (UXO) removal. Fuel shortages also complicate the winterisation response, further affecting children's ability to attend school regularly. In parallel, Syrian teachers, particularly in rural areas, face significant transportation challenges due to limited and costly public transport.

Population Movement

Since 27 November, more than 627,000 people including over 275,000 children remain displaced across the country, primarily in Idleb and Aleppo, according to the IDP Taskforce. From the peak of 1.1 million newly displaced persons (over 483,00 children) on 12 December, it is estimated that approximately 522,000 people had returned to their areas of origin by 2 January.⁵ In Northeast Syria, approximately 25,800 IDPs remain in over 183 collective centres, many of which lack sufficient water, sanitation facilities, and privacy.⁶

Since 8 December, a total of 58,350 Syrians (26 per cent men, 28 per cent women, and 46 per cent children) have returned to Syria, mainly from Lebanon, Jordan, and Türkiye. The primary destinations for these returns are Ar-Raqqa, followed by Aleppo, Homs, and Dar'a. While still limited in scale, this reflects a continued, gradual increase in refugee returns over recent weeks. The Government of Türkiye has announced the establishment of a mechanism for temporary "go-and-see" visits from 1 January to 1 July 2025, allowing heads of households to visit Syria up to three times during this six-month period.⁷ As of 29 December, an estimated 419,200 Syrian refugees have returned to Syria since the start of 2024.⁸

² Figures reported to the FTS may differ for same period due to exchange rate fluctuations, variances in recovery costs, and changes resulting from end-of-year processes and ongoing allocations of flexible funding. Given the expanding needs and ongoing Emergency Response Plan process, needs and related financial requirements are being assessed which may require revisions of the HAC 2025. The sectoral breakdown is provisional and can be updated based on the needs/gaps.

³ OCHA WoS Flash Update No. 10 on the recent developments in Syria, 7 January 2025.

⁴ Ibid.

⁵ Ibid.

⁶ Ibid.

⁷ UNHCR Regional Flash Update #7, Syria situation crisis, 27 December 2024.

⁸ UNHCR Response Factsheet, 30 December 2024.

Summary Analysis of Programme Response

UNICEF Programme Response Strategy

UNICEF's Emergency Response builds on its ongoing programmes and the existing response is being scaled-up to address both immediate and medium-term needs of the affected population, while also planning for longer-term needs.

Health

Between 22 and 30 December, the situation began to improve as many Primary Health Centres (PHCs) and partners resumed operations, providing essential health services to people in need. Healthcare services were delivered through both health centres and mobile teams, ensuring continuity of care for remote and underserved populations. In Homs and Hama governorates, UNICEF activities have resumed in health and immunization centres, despite access challenges, however northern Hama is still inaccessible due to security concerns.

In Northwest Syria (NWS), UNICEF supported life-saving child health services through PHC facilities and community-based approaches. 1,727 children (828 girls and 899 boys) received medical treatment for various conditions, while 2,239 adults (1,614 women and 625 men) were treated at PHC facilities and outreach services through mobile health teams. To enhance health promotion and disease prevention at the community level, 88 Community Health Workers conducted health education and counselling sessions, reaching over 150 individuals (110 women and 40 men).

In the rest of the country, 8,158 individuals received primary healthcare consultations, including 5,208 children (2,660 girls and 2,548 boys) and 2,950 adults (2,937 women and 13 men). Since 27 November, 28,560 individuals have received primary healthcare consultations, comprising 10,098 girls, 10,799 boys, 7,509 women, and 154 men.

Vaccination efforts were significantly scaled up, with 5,520 children under one receiving the first dose of the pentavalent vaccine (Penta1) and 4,848 children completing the full vaccination series with the third dose (Penta3), safeguarding them from life-threatening diseases. Additional vaccinations included 487 children (251 girls and 236 boys) receiving the measles, mumps, and rubella (MMR) vaccine, and 563 children (281 girls and 282 boys), receiving the diphtheria, tetanus and pertussis (DTP3) vaccine. Additionally, 25,000 doses of Oral Cholera Vaccines were delivered to Al-Hol camp in Qamishli to address the Cholera outbreak.

Furthermore, over 2,156 individuals participated in community-based dialogues, awareness-raising sessions, consultation meetings, and help desk services. These activities promoted health awareness, offered individual and group consultations, and enhanced access to both mobile and centre-based support.

Nutrition

UNICEF through its implementing partners continued to provide preventive and curative nutrition services for children under five and pregnant and lactating women (PLW). Partners were also able to resume nutrition services in Northeast Syria (NES) and around Damascus and have expanded their presence across the country through fixed clinics and mobile teams to support displaced populations affected by ongoing conflict.

In NWS, nutrition services were provided at 16 Outpatient Therapeutic Programme (OTP) sites and the community level, supported by 96 Community Health Workers (52 women and 44 men). Key activities included screening children and PLWs and referring them to OTPs for treatment and further management. 174 women received counselling on proper Maternal IYCF practices. Over 2,677 children were screened for early malnutrition identification, with 7 children (5 girls and 2 boys) identified with Severe Acute Malnutrition and enrolled in OTP centres for treatment. Additionally, 1,214 PLWs were screened for malnutrition, and 287 received Multiple Micronutrient Supplements, while 589 children received Multiple Micronutrient Products.

In the rest of the country, 3,285 children aged 6-59 months were screened for child wasting (1,644 girls and 1,641 boys), with 17 children (9 girls and 8 boys) treated for severe wasting while 35 others were referred for treatment of moderate wasting. Since the start of the response, a total of 15,285 children (7,795 girls and 7,490 boys) have been screened, with 57 admitted for treatment of severe wasting.

Over 1,700 PLWs received a package of nutrition services, including screening for acute malnutrition, counselling on optimal IYCF, and iron folate supplementation. Since the beginning of the response, a total of 5,136 PLWs have been reached with these services.

WASH

UNICEF is committed to ensure safe WASH services for all people in Syria. Notably, UNICEF has successfully completed the Ein Al Baida pumping station testing and when the water network is fully rehabilitated, safe drinking water will reach over 260,000 people in Al Bab city and surrounding villages in Aleppo governorate. At the moment, water is

not yet reaching Al Bab due to the low operationality of Al Khafsa water station, as Tishreen dam is not providing power. In response to the reduced capacity of the Al-Khafsa main pumping and treatment station, following the recent clashes, UNICEF is working with partners and the water authority to secure safe drinking water for over 1 million people in Aleppo. UNICEF is also conducting final emergency interventions at the Tishreen Dam, which is critical for ensuring adequate water supply for 1 million people in Aleppo governorate, by repairing the main water pumping line.

In As-Sweida city, UNICEF has secured safe drinking water for more than 350,000 people by supplying 600 litres of fuel. Additionally, UNICEF remains committed to ensuring safe drinking water across all governorates by continuing to deliver water disinfection materials.

In NWS, UNICEF partners have provided WASH services to 398,326 people (101,673 boys, 114,089 girls, 83,438 men, and 99,126 women, including 41,577 people with disabilities) in Idlib and Aleppo governorates. This includes 242,145 people served through water stations in Idlib city and 156,001 through sanitation services in Afrin. In the past week, 50,060 people (13,015 boys, 14,514 girls, 10,518 men, and 12,013 women) in 36 communities and IDP camps were reached with emergency water provision mainly through water trucking, maintenance of water services, and sanitation support. Hygiene promotion activities, including cholera prevention, reached 10,560 people. Additionally, UNICEF supplied water treatment chemicals to WASH Cluster partners, ensuring safe water for 13,228 vulnerable individuals.

To meet immediate water needs, UNICEF will begin water trucking operations, delivering 8,500 litres of drinking water daily to the communities of Ma'arrat An Nu'man and Khan Shaykun in Idlib Governorate, benefiting around 5,500 people each day.

Hygiene kits are being prepared for distribution to 82 IDP shelters in Ar-Raqqa, directly assisting 2,000 families. Additionally, new WASH facilities have been installed at Al Tabka Stadium, with 25 more planned across Ar-Raqqa and Al-Hasakeh. In Al-Hasakeh, jerry cans have been distributed to 1,000 families, and cleaning operations for WASH facilities in five IDP centres in Qamishli and Ar-Raqqa have been conducted, with light maintenance planned for 37 more facilities in Ar-Raqqa. UNICEF is preparing 800 cleaning kits for IDP shelters and has distributed 125 water tanks across shelters in Al-Hasakeh, Qamishli, and Ar-Raqqa.

Child Protection

UNICEF continues to prioritise three key areas in child protection: safeguarding vulnerable children from violence (including gender-based violence, recruitment by armed groups, and exposure to unexploded ordnance (EORE), providing structured Mental Health and Psychological Support (MHPSS) and Psychological First Aid (PFA), case management for child protection (CP) and gender-based violence (GBV), and the prevention of sexual exploitation and abuse (PSEA). These interventions are provided through mobile teams and child-friendly spaces, ensuring direct engagement with children and caregivers. This integrated approach enhances the effectiveness and reach of support for those most in need.

In NWS, UNICEF partners reached 14,171 people (5,958 girls and 5,462 boys, 1,461 women and 1,290 men) including 70 people with disabilities (PwDs) since 27 November. The total reach includes 5,926 IDPs and 8,245 host communities. During the reporting period, UNICEF partners reached 4,075 individuals with EORE, including 1,657 boys, 1,980 girls, 221 men, and 217 women. Additionally, 676 individuals were provided with MHPSS and PFA (240 boys, 334 girls, 11 men, and 91 women), with 125 boys and 270 girls participating in recreational activities. 68 children (25 girls and 33 boys) received case management for CP and GBV. UNICEF partners also conducted PSEA awareness-raising and community mobilisation activities, reaching 5,644 individuals (2,072 boys, 2,646 girls, 381 men, and 545 women).

In the rest of the country, structured MHPSS services reached 694 children (360 girls and 334 boys), and 62 caregivers (41 women and 21 men) benefitted from the Parenting Support programme. PFA was provided to 18,764 children (9,983 girls and 8,781 boys) and 3,276 adults (2,175 women and 1,101 men). Additionally, 3,061 children (1,615 girls and 1,446 boys) participated in recreational activities. Case management services assisted 134 children (72 girls and 62 boys), and 146 children were referred to basic and specialised services. EORE was delivered to 6,463 children (3,192 girls and 3,271 boys) and 1,776 adults (1,010 women and 766 men). Awareness sessions on Child Protection reached 4,356 children and 1,289 adults, while GBV awareness session reached 1,345 children and 630 adults. PSEA messages were shared with 3,535 individuals (2,177 children and 1,358 adults).

Despite these efforts, UNICEF's child protection response in Syria faces significant challenges, particularly due to security concerns. Violence, theft, and kidnappings restrict the movement of both beneficiaries and humanitarian workers, especially in Homs and Hama Governorates. Fear of crime and conflict has discouraged families from accessing child-friendly spaces and other essential services, leaving many children without support. Additionally, the presence of explosive remnants heightens safety risks, and the psychological distress caused by violence remains a critical concern.

Education

In NWS, 24,693 children (13,690 girls and 11,003 boys) accessed quality formal and non-formal education services with support from UNICEF partners. Of the total, 18,970 children (10,376 girls and 8,594 boys) benefited from formal and non-formal education (NFE) services and supplies, while 5,723 children (3,314 girls and 2,409 boys) participated in non-formal education through catch-up classes and the Self-Learning Programme (SLP). Additionally, nearly 4,000 children were provided with safe, conducive learning environment through the installation of 20 new semi-permanent classrooms across 10 schools. Approximately 10,000 children in 25 schools have received winterization support, including fuel, heaters, and maintenance costs for learning spaces. Moreover, 30 children accessed PSS support and referrals through education settings, and 664 children (400 girls and 264 boys) were newly reached with PSEA awareness-raising activities.

In the rest of the country including NES, UNICEF and its partners have reached 7,376 children, including 3,974 girls, and 125 returnee children (72 girls and 53 boys) through non-formal education activities. These activities include Self-Learning Programme (SLP), remedial classes, recreational activities, digital learning, and Early Childhood Education (ECE) in Lattakia and Idlib. In Deir Ez-Zor, 261 children (including 16 children with disabilities - CwD) benefited from non-formal education activities including SLP, remedial classes and ECE. Additionally, to enhance the learning environment UNICEF has begun providing solar power systems to 12 schools, and an additional four schools received cleaning kits.

Social Protection

Liquidation restrictions continue to prevent UNICEF from reaching beneficiaries involved in the two cash-plus programmes. As a result, only 42 children with disabilities (CwD) have been reached under the integrated social protection programme while the CwD lists in other governorates remain inactive. Similarly, around 3,300 beneficiary families in the Cash for Basic Needs Programme in Aleppo, Al-Hasakeh, and Rural Damascus are still unable to receive their second payments, as the liquidation restrictions has halted cash distribution.

From 27 November to 29 December, UNICEF reached a total of 4,864 people (2,169 women and 2,695 men), including 4,063 children (1,765 girls and 2,298 boys), through cash-plus programmes. This includes 3,174 CwD (1,333 girls and 1,841 boys) across five governorates (215 in Homs, 662 in Rural Damascus, 1,721 in Al-Hasakeh, 569 in Hama, and 7 in Aleppo) for the integrated social protection programme, and 1,690 people (836 women and 854 men), including 889 children (457 girls and 432 boys), in Aleppo and Rural Damascus for the Cash for Basic Needs Programme.

While cash distribution is minimal, both social protection programmes remain functional. Case managers are visiting beneficiaries to follow up on required services, and implementing partners are updating the service map as new service providers become available.

Adolescent Development and Participation (ADAP)

UNICEF adapted its response based on local security conditions, focusing on key interventions during emergencies. Trained young volunteers were mobilised to support IDPs, youth-led initiatives, digital engagement, and the dissemination of Risk Communication and Community Engagement (RCCE), SBC, and PSEA messages, while also participating in rapid needs assessments. Capacity-building continued to help young people support their communities during crises.

In response to IDP movements from Aleppo to Ar-Raqqa and Al-Hasakeh governorates, 122 young volunteers (38 female and 84 male) engaged in health awareness and relief efforts, while 155 (68 females, 87 males) attended life skills sessions. Additionally, 89 young people (39 female and 55 male) participated in sports activities, whereas PSEA sessions reached 237 young people (135 female and 138 male). Security instability led to challenges such as reduced beneficiaries and staff turnover. In Aleppo, ADAP continued through centres and mobile teams, with 479 young people (441 female and 38 male) attending life skills sessions and 497 young people (369 female and 128 male) benefiting from vocational training. PSEA sessions reached 118 young people (75 female and 43 male), while security issues led to reduced working hours. In Hama, 60 volunteers (31 female and 29 male) conducted landmine awareness campaigns in schools. 41 young volunteers (25 female and 16 male) addressed psychological trauma, while 47 of them (18 female and 29 male) painted murals. In Mardes, 25 volunteers (12 female and 13 male) installed curtains in a war-damaged school.

Social and Behavioural Change (SBC)

In the reporting period, SBC field volunteers supported the response across different governorates, facilitating reflective dialogues with communities, including women and children, and addressing community concerns, including safety, health, and nutrition. Since December 2024, 25,083 community members (18,630 women and girls) have been reached through field SBC interventions, and around 70,000 individuals have been engaged through social media activities.

In Aleppo, 7,100 people (4,993 women and girls) participated in dialogues and outreach on immunization, cholera prevention, and IYCF. In Ar-Raqqa and Al-Hasakeh, 2,512 community members (including 1,743 women and girls) engaged in health, hygiene, IYCF, and mental health activities. Recreational activities reached 152 children and adolescents, while 479 children and 154 mothers were screened for malnutrition, resulting in 851 referrals to service providers. In Homs, 583 individuals (including 395 women and girls) attended life-saving sessions, and 117 children participated in edutainment activities. In Rural Damascus, UNICEF-supported teams, in collaboration with the Directorate of Health, conducted household visits to screen children under-five for routine immunization and refer their caregivers to follow-up with MoH health teams.

Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP)

Between 23 and 29 December, UNICEF's service line addressed 31 cases, mostly from Aleppo, Deir-ez-Zor, Hama, Lattakia, Tartous, Ar-Raqqa, Quneitra, and Rural Damascus. This brings the total number of cases received since 27 November to 134. Of the recent cases, 64 per cent were information requests (related to the Social Protection Programme, mainly about cash payments and education services), while the rest involved complaints and requests for additional support, such as food kits. All cases have been resolved except for three, which are still being followed up on. These cases are being managed and closed in coordination with the relevant programme teams. UNICEF's Planning and Monitoring team ensures that appropriate actions are taken for each reported case. Additionally, through the AAP inter-agency working group, UNICEF is discussing a coordinated emergency response to ensure proper information, complaints, feedback mechanisms, and community consultations.

Humanitarian Leadership, Coordination and Strategy

UNICEF leads the coordination of the WASH, Nutrition, and Education sectors, and the Child Protection Area of Responsibility (AoR) at both the Whole of Syria (WoS) level in Amman and the hub levels in Gaziantep and Damascus. The four WoS sectors collaborate closely, holding regular meetings with teams and partners from the NWS, NES, and Damascus hubs. This collaboration ensures a coordinated response that upholds humanitarian principles, including access, response capacity, the "Do No Harm" principle, and duty of care. By maintaining this structured approach, UNICEF and its sectoral partners can respond effectively to the evolving needs on the ground, ensuring that the most vulnerable populations receive the essential support and services they need. This coordinated effort is vital for ensuring a unified and effective humanitarian response across the region.

Regarding the Child Protection AoR, most partners have resumed activities, providing various child protection interventions in centres and through mobile teams. New organisations have joined the AoR in the coastal areas, however, security remains unstable in areas like Homs, Hama, Aleppo, and the coast, limiting access to child-friendly spaces and CP services. Other challenges include delays in fund transfers, rising fuel costs, and disruptions to internet and mobile services.

In Aleppo governorate, partners are active in 26 centres and through 12 mobile teams, focusing on psychological first aid (PFA), recreational activities, case management, and exposure to unexploded ordnance due to widespread contamination and weapons. Partners in Homs and Hama provided MHPSS to 429 children, positive parenting to 247 caregivers, and child protection awareness to 388 children and 58 caregivers, along with EORE to 761 children. In the coastal areas, child protection partners responded to families affected by the hostilities in Bmalkeh village and are monitoring impacts on Kherbit Al Maazi village. In Aleppo, partners face challenges due to looted centres and restricted areas access to certain areas. In NES, UNICEF remains the main CP actor. In NWS, partners have expanded PFA and PSS programmes targeting displaced children and caregivers in camps and shelters. Efforts to support the reintegration of children released from detention, including family tracing and registration, are ongoing. In addition to providing specialised child protection services, such as PFA, MHPSS, and reintegration, the CP AoR partners are placing increased focus on children with disabilities (CwDs) and survivors of explosive remnants of war (ERW) accidents. Progress continues in tracing and reuniting separated children with their families, particularly in newly accessible areas.

In Aleppo governorate, nutrition services are being delivered through 56 fixed centres and 5 mobile teams, covering Aleppo city, rural areas, and Al Nerab camp, with support from UNICEF, WFP, and WHO. In NWS, all nutrition partners in Idleb and Aleppo governorates are active, with some partners beginning their response in the RAATA areas (Ras Al Ain, Tel Refat, Tel Abyad). A total of 7,345 children aged 6 to 59 months (3,387 boys and 3,958 girls) were screened for malnutrition across Idleb, Ar-Raqqa, and north Aleppo. In response to the influx of IDPs from Aleppo to Tabqa and Al-Hasakeh, six mobile teams screened 5,006 children and 675 PLW. In other areas of the country, 721 pregnant and breastfeeding women and 3,121 children under five were reached between 2 and 29 December, with 20 cases of malnutrition (including six severe cases) identified in children, and 59 cases of moderate acute malnutrition in women. Additionally, 3,696 caregivers received IYCF counselling. In Al-Hasakeh governorate in NES, the Department of Health suspended seven CMAM centres due to a change in control of the Government, and two centres in Ar-Raqqa halted operations due to security issues. New mobile teams are unable to receive Ready-to-Use Supplementary Food (RUSF) from WFP, so cases of moderate acute malnutrition (MAM) in children are being treated with Ready-to-Use Therapeutic Food (RUTF) from UNICEF, while pregnant and lactating women are referred to Supplementary Feeding Programmes. Action Against Hunger and the Department of Health in Al-Hasakeh have also suspended activities due to the uncertain

situation, and no distribution of Lipid Nutrient Supplements (LNS-SQ) has occurred in Al-Hasakeh due to delays in shipments from Damascus.

Under UNICEF's leadership as co-lead of the Education Cluster, school rehabilitation and the installation of Temporary Learning Spaces are ongoing in NWS, providing a safe and conducive learning environment for up to 11,000 children in both formal and non-formal schools. Additionally, more than 10,000 children have received winterization packages, including winter clothes, fuel, and heaters. A national mapping is currently being conducted with cluster partners across all hubs to assess the capacity of various education partners to respond. The Education Cluster is also tracking teacher and student movements to monitor newly displaced or returnee students and ensure their reintegration into available education services.

All 39 active WASH NWS Cluster partners have resumed operations across 1,013 IDP camps and 130 communities. However, concerns have arisen over the sharp increase in fuel prices, which could impact critical lifesaving activities such as water trucking and emergency dislodging, particularly in IDP camps. With extended access in Aleppo and Idleb governorates, beyond the usual NWS areas, 7 WASH Cluster partners have begun addressing critical gaps in Aleppo, including the rehabilitation of water stations and networks, as well as solid waste management, with clearance from the WoS WASH Cluster. Additionally, smaller-scale activities have been carried out to meet immediate needs, such as distributing 3,600 water bottles and 400 hygiene kits in targeted locations.

Human Interest Stories and External Media

Aligned with its commitment to the rights and well-being of children, UNICEF in Syria continues to prioritise amplifying the voices of children and young people, ensuring that all communication and advocacy efforts adhere to safeguarding principles, ethical standards, and stringent safety protocols.

In response to recent developments, UNICEF has significantly increased its advocacy efforts, producing over 15 multimedia assets, including compelling videos and photo collections, and publishing more than 50 social media posts. These included messages promoting psychosocial well-being and raising awareness about the dangers of remnants of war.

Additionally, UNICEF engaged extensively with the media, with spokespeople conducting over 27 interviews. These advocacy efforts emphasised the urgent need for unimpeded humanitarian access, the protection of children and essential infrastructure, and enhanced investment in social services and human resources to support children across Syria.



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Mohamed, 11, chats with a UNICEF staff member in front of a UNICEF-supported child protection centre in Aleppo, Syria, on 5 December 2024.

Mohamed regularly visits the centre and participates in psychosocial support sessions.

"I like coming to the centre to attend the sessions and improve myself. I've learned to think carefully before reacting," he shared.

You can also view footage related to:

- UNICEF strengthening the mental health of caregivers and children in Aleppo following recent hostilities [here](#);
- UNICEF empowering education in Aleppo, providing inclusive learning for Syria's children [here](#);
- UNICEF addressing the evolving needs of children and families with vital support and services [here](#)
- The rapidly evolving humanitarian context in Syria [here](#)

Next SitRep: 12 January 2025

UNICEF Syria Crisis: <https://www.unicef.org/emergencies/syrian-crisis>

UNICEF Syria and Syrian Refugees Humanitarian Action for Children Appeal: <https://www.unicef.org/appeals/>

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Annex A - Funding Status of 2025 HAC requirements.

Consolidated Funding by Sector

Programme	Requirements (US\$)	Available funds (US\$)	Funding gap (US\$)	Funding gap (%)
Health & Nutrition	111,730,183	19,722,700	92,007,483	82%
WASH	126,735,233	14,556,733	112,178,499	89%
Education	133,893,107	8,112,271	125,780,836	94%
Child Protection	45,235,385	6,698,177	38,537,208	85%
ADAP	13,672,685	584,588	13,088,097	96%
SP	55,579,937	3,324,650	52,255,287	94%
PSEA	685,385		685,385	100%
SBC/RCCE	761,538		761,538	100%
Grand Total	488,293,452	52,999,119	435,294,333	89%